MORNING HIP RESET

5 minutes, right out of bed - hips + lower back wake-up (do BEFORE coffee)

Pairs with the Ankle Mobility Protocol (root cause of the squat hip shift) - alternate or stack them

1

CAT-COW

8-10 slow cycles

Hands and knees. Arch the back up (cat), then drop the belly and lift the chest (cow). Move with the breath. Pumps fluid into the stiff morning spine.

2

WORLD'S GREATEST STRETCH

5 per side, slow

Deep lunge, hands inside the front foot. Drop the back knee, reach the inside arm up, rotate the chest open. Hip flexor + hamstring + mid back in one move.

3

90/90 HIP SWITCHES

10 switches

Sit, both legs bent 90 deg - one knee in front, one out to the side. Slowly roll both knees left to right without hands. Trains the hips' full internal + external rotation range.

4

COBRA PRESS-UP

8 reps, 3 s hold

Face down, hands under shoulders. Press the chest up, hips stay on the floor. Wakes up spinal extension - the motion desks, exams and sleep never give you.

5

GLUTE BRIDGE

12 reps, 1 s squeeze

On your back, knees bent, feet flat. Drive through the heels, lift hips, squeeze glutes hard at the top. Re-activates the muscles sleep switched off.

6

HIP FLEXOR LUNGE STRETCH

30-45 s per side

Half-kneel, squeeze the glute of the back leg, push hips forward gently until the front of that hip stretches. Tall chest. Tight flexors = the morning hip lock.

HIP-SHIFT CORRECTION ADD-ON (for the squat)

- The shift is driven by ankle stiffness first (see ankle protocol). These add hip-side support:
- Side plank 2 x 20-30 s, WEAK side first - builds the lateral hip wall that keeps hips level
- Single-leg balance 2 x 30 s per leg, eyes open then closed - wakes up hip stabilizers
- In squats: heel plate under LEFT heel + cue 'sit between the hips' until mobility catches up